

July

11

1405 Treasure voyage

Chinese admiral Zheng He, with his fleet of 317 ships, received the command to set sail on his first voyage of exploration to Southeast Asia and India in search of treasure.



Born this day

1923 Tun Tun, Indian comedian and singer. The first female comedian in Bollywood, she appeared in more than 100 films.

1957 Michael Rose, Jamaican musician. He was lead singer of the reggae group Black Uhuru, who in 1985 won the first-ever Grammy Award for Best Reggae Album.



1899

1897 Arctic tragedy

Swedish explorer

S A Andrée and two companions set off from Norway in a disastrous attempt to reach the North Pole by hot-air balloon. They disappeared and the balloon was not found until 33 years later.



Also on this day

1801 French astronomer

Jean-Louis Pons found the first of the 37 comets discovered by him.

1914 US baseball legend Babe

Ruth made his debut in the Major League as a pitcher.

2018 Scientists reported finding

2.1-million-year-old stone tools in China, suggesting that humans left Africa much earlier than assumed.

Founding FIAT

A group of investors, including Italian entrepreneur Giovanni Agnelli, founded FIAT (Fabbrica Italiana Automobili Torino) in Turin, Italy. Under Agnelli's leadership, FIAT became the largest manufacturer of cars in the country.